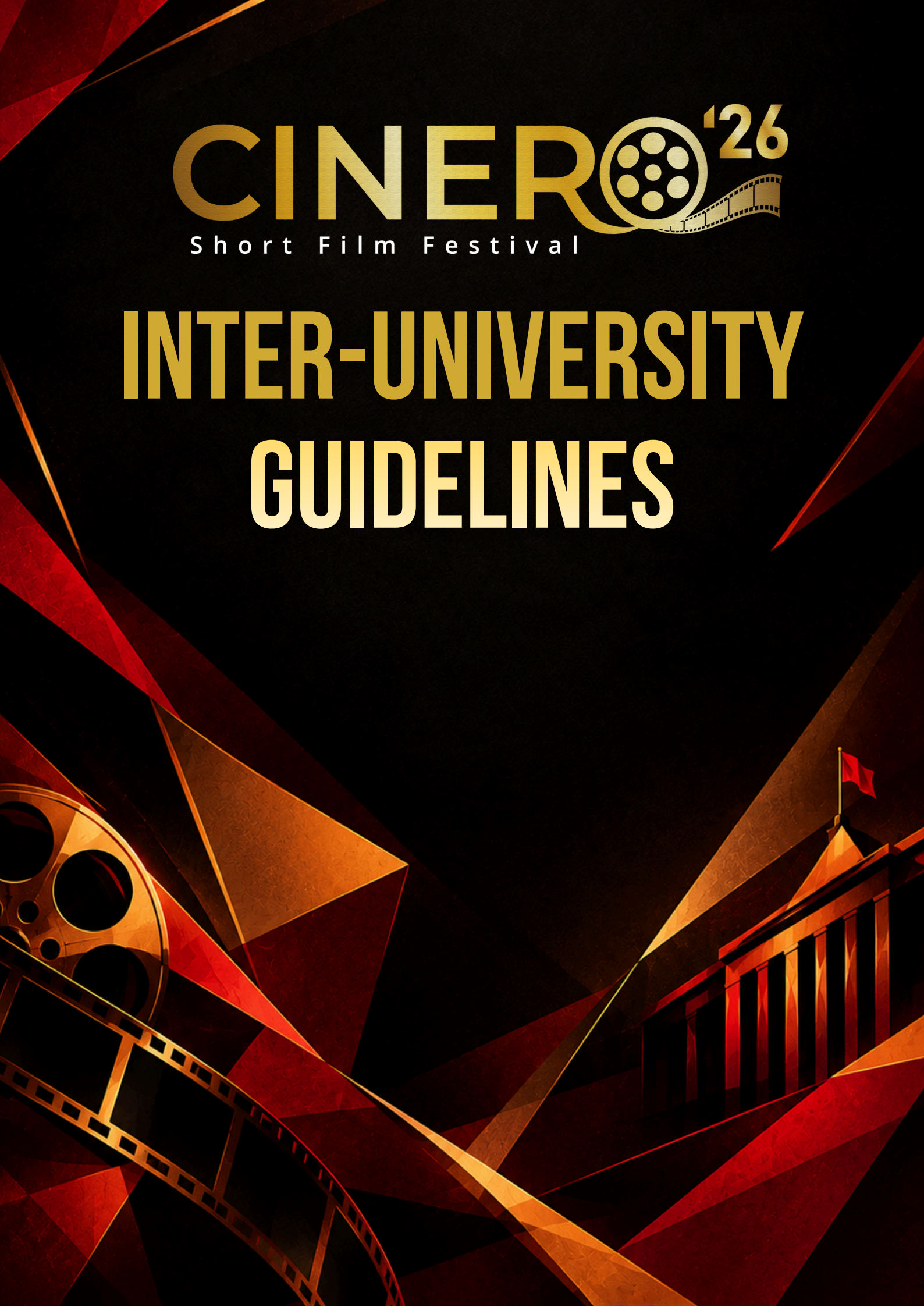
CINERO '26

Short Film Festival

INTER-UNIVERSITY GUIDELINES



1. FESTIVAL GUIDELINES

Common Rules for Both Categories

REGISTRATION REQUIREMENT:

Only teams that have successfully completed the official CINERO'26 registration process are eligible to submit films. Film submissions from unregistered teams will not be accepted or considered for the competition.

1.1 ORIGINALITY AND COPYRIGHT

- All submitted films must be original works created by the participating team.
- Submitted films must remain unpublished on all open-access streaming platforms, including YouTube and Facebook, throughout the competition period.
- Music, footage, images, graphics, fonts, and other materials must be original, royalty-free, or properly licensed.
- Participants are responsible for obtaining the necessary permissions for all copyrighted materials used in their films.
- Films must not contain plagiarism or unauthorized use of another person's work.

1.2 LANGUAGE AND SUBTITLES

- All films must include embedded English subtitles so that the judges and audience can understand the content.
- Separate dialogue lists will not be accepted as a replacement for subtitles.

1.3 TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

All submitted films must meet the following technical requirements:

- File format: MP4 or MOV
- Resolution: Full HD (1920 × 1080) or higher
- Video codec: H.264
- Audio: 2.0 Stereo

1.4 PROMOTIONAL RIGHTS

- By participating, teams grant CINERO'26 non-exclusive permission to use their film posters, trailers, selected clips, and team photographs for festival-related promotional purposes.
- The original ownership of the films remains with their creators.

1.5 JUDGING AND FINAL DECISIONS

- Films will be evaluated by a panel of judges with relevant filmmaking expertise.
- The judging panel's decisions on awards and rankings will be final.
- The Organizing Committee reserves the right to reject entries that do not comply with the official guidelines.



2. INTER-UNIVERSITY CATEGORY GUIDELINES

Rules Specifically for University Undergraduates

2.1 ELIGIBILITY AND PARTICIPATION

- The competition is open to currently enrolled undergraduate students of recognized universities.
- Graduates are not eligible to participate.
- All team members must be from the same university. Students from different universities cannot form a team together.
- Each team must consist of a minimum of 4 members and a maximum of 15 members.
- Each student may participate in only one team.
- A university may register multiple teams.

2.2 FILM REQUIREMENTS

- Films must be created on or after 1 January 2026.
- The film must have a running time of 5–15 minutes, including opening and closing credits.
- The topic is open, but pornography, nudity, explicit violence, harmful content, and personal insults are prohibited.
- Films must be in Sinhala, Tamil, or English.
- Embedded English subtitles are compulsory.

2.3 REQUIRED SUBMISSION MATERIALS

Each participating team must submit the following:

1. Completed short film
2. Creative film poster
3. Completed Script
4. Team declaration

All materials must be submitted through the official submission process announced by the Organizing Committee.

2.4 REGISTRATION AND COPYRIGHT

- Registration fee: LKR 1,000 per team member.
- Teams must register and submit their films through the official links provided by the Organizing Committee.
- A member of the Organizing Committee will contact the team via WhatsApp or telephone to confirm receipt.
- § All submissions must be completed before the official deadline. Late submissions will not be accepted.

2.5 JUDGING AND SCREENING

Films will be evaluated by a panel of judges with relevant filmmaking expertise, based on:

- Storytelling and screenplay
- Acting and performances
- Directing and creative vision
- Cinematography and visual quality
- Editing and technical execution
- Production Design and Styling

Awards will be presented in the following categories:

- Best Director
- Best Screenplay
- Best Actor
- Best Actress
- Best Cinematographer
- Best Editor
- Best Makeup and Production Styling

The Top 10 finalist teams will be selected and officially invited to the award ceremony.
Shortlisted university-category films will be screened at official festival venues organized by J'PURA VOICE.

2.6 CASH PRIZES

1st Place
LKR 75,000

2nd Place
LKR 50,000

3rd Place
LKR 30,000

